A-A-383
July 24, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

POLISH, METAL (SILVER)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification P-P-580.

This commercial item description covers a combination silver polisher-cleaner-tarnish preventive, for use on sterling silver and silver plated articles.

Salient characteristics:

The silver polish shall be a liquid containing a finely divided abrasive suitable for polishing silver and containing tarnish preventive material that remains on the silver after polishing. It shall be free from cyanides or any ingredients or solvents having a detrimental effect on silver or personnel.

pH. The polish shall have a pH of not less than 5.0 when tested in accordance with ASTM E 70.

Flammability. The polish shall have a flash point of not less than 140°F (60°C) when tested in accordance with ASTM D 92.

Caking properties. The separated abrasive material of the polish shall be soft and easily redispersed by stirring or shaking under the following conditons. Place forty ml of the well-stirred polished in a 75 ml cylindrical glass bottle, 1-1/2 inches in diameter, and centrifuge for 15 minutes at 1500 rpm. Examine the separated abrasive material with a glass rod to determine evidence of caking.

Cleaning efficiency. The polish shall have a cleaning efficiency of not less than 85 percent using the following method:

Materials and equipment:

(a) Smooth, rolled, sterling silver panels, 4 x 4 x 1/16 inches. The silver alloy shall be 92 ± 1 percent silver and 7.0 ± 0.5 percent copper with a hardness of 30 to 50 on the Rockwell B scale. The silver panels shall be suitably mounted on a firm base.

(b) A polishing machine having a 4-inch polishing head. The head shall have a rubber pad (1/4 inch min.) cemented to the head. A wrinkle free piece of billiard cloth shall be placed over the polishing head. The total weight of the polishing head shall be 4.0 ± 0.1 pounds.

(c) 60° Specular Gloss Meter using ASTM D 523.

(d) A saturated solution of potassium sulfide.

Preparation of panels. Clean two silver panels using a jeweler's rouge slurry. The cleaned panels shall have a 60° specular gloss of 77 percent minimum.

Procedure. Record the gloss of the test panels. Tarnish the panels by immersion in the saturated potassium sulfide solution, maintained at 100° ± 2°F for 2 minutes. Rinse in distilled water and blot dry. Apply 10 ml of the test polish to the polishing head and polish the panel for 114 strokes. Apply 5 ml more on polishing head and rotate the panel 90°, polish for 114 strokes. Repeat two more times. Rinse panels in distilled water and blot dry. Measure the specular gloss of the panels.

$$\text{Cleaning efficiency, percent} = \frac{\text{gloss of soiled panel} \times 100}{\text{gloss of clean panel}}$$

Tarnish resistance. The polish shall have a tarnish resistance of not less than 85 percent using the following method.

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Preparation of panels. Apply the polish to two clean silver panels as specified in the above procedure.

Procedure. Measure the gloss of the two polished panels and record. Place the panels in a desiccator in the presence of ammonium sulfide vapor for one hour. The ammonium sulfide shall be present as a water solution consisting of 100 ml of distilled water and 1 ml of a 1 percent solution of ammonium sulfide. Remove the panels at the end of test, rinse in distilled water, blot dry, and read the specular gloss of the two panels.

$$\text{Tarnish resistance, percent} = \frac{\text{gloss of exposed panel} \times 100}{\text{gloss of clean, polished panel}}$$

The issue of ASTM test methods in effect on the date of the solution shall be used to determine compliance with these requirements.

Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product sold in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Packaging, packing, and marking. Packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

MILITARY INTEREST:

No Interest

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

CPSC
GSA-FSS, PBO
VA-DMS

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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inspection ... Level C. Rinse additive shall be packaged to afford adequate